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Data show that females continue to be underrepresented in many high-paying fields, which are predominantly masculine-typed industries such as aeronautics, engineering, medical surgery, business (executive-level), and computer science/technology. Data also show that within all job categories, even those considered feminine-typed, females are still paid less than their male peers, a phenomenon sociologists call the gender pay (or wage) gap (Figure 1). The gender pay gap persists even when differences in hours worked, job choice, education, and other qualifications are taken into account. Research suggests that mothers earn less than men and women who are not mothers, a phenomenon termed the "motherhood penalty" by sociologists.

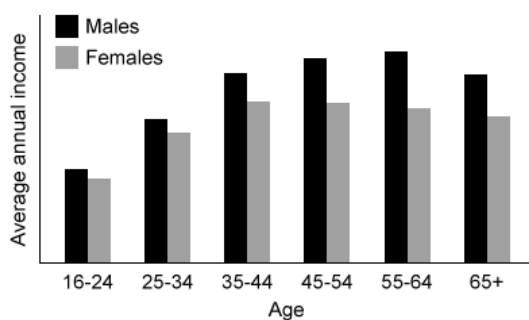


Figure 1 Gender pay gap by age

Based on the second paragraph of the passage, occupational sex/gender segregation in the U.S. is perpetuated as a result of all of the following EXCEPT:

- ☐ A. role strain. [8%]

- ✓ ☒ B. social loafing. [75%]
☐ C. hidden curriculum. [9%]
☐ D. institutional discrimination. [6%]

Correct

75% answered correctly

Explanation:

Sex/gender segregation describes the **separation** of **males** and **females** by means that may be formal (eg, laws) or informal (eg, social norms). Occupational sex/gender segregation in the U.S. is exemplified by masculine-typed occupations (eg, construction work) that are generally fulfilled by males and feminine-typed occupations (eg, nursing) that are generally fulfilled by females.

Social loafing occurs when an individual expends less effort when working as part of a group than when working alone (eg, people tend to clap less loudly as part of a group than when no one else is clapping). The second paragraph does not discuss social loafing as a factor causing occupational sex/gender segregation in the U.S.

(Choice A) Males who avoid pink-collar professions due to conflict between status expectations are dodging role strain, which occurs when competing expectations (eg, masculinity vs. a job that is perceived as "feminine") for a single status (eg, male nurse) cause discomfort or stress. Role strain, which prevents males from considering certain pink-collar professions, contributes to sex/gender segregation in employment.

(Choice C) Hidden curriculum refers to all of the messages transmitted to students in an academic setting that are not based on content (eg, norms, attitudes, beliefs). Unintended messages conveyed by the informal curriculum (ie, hidden curriculum) that male students do not belong in a profession may lead to male attrition in pink-collar occupation training programs, contributing to sex/gender segregation in employment.

(Choice D) The glass escalator exemplifies institutional discrimination because it involves systemic actions or policies that benefit one group (males) at the expense of another (females) based on group stereotypes (ie, "men are better leaders than women"). This contributes to sex/gender segregation as more males occupy top-level management roles while females remain at lower levels.

Educational objective:

Sex/gender segregation describes the separation of males and females by formal (ie, laws) or informal (ie, social norms) means.

Time spent: 0 sec

Subject:

Behavioral Sciences

QID: 401490

System:

Demographics and Social Structure

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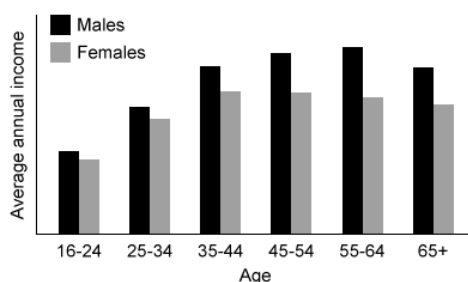


Figure 1 Gender pay gap by age

The unintended consequences of the two major U.S. economic transitions described in the passage are most closely aligned with which sociological framework?

- ☐ A. Symbolic interactionism [13%]
- ☐ B. Exchange-rational choice [5%]
- ☐ C. Conflict theory [23%]
- ✓ ☒ D. Structural functionalism [58%]

Correct
58% answered correctly

Explanation:

Functionalism: Manifest vs. latent functions	
Manifest functions	Latent functions
Intended, obvious purpose of a social structure (eg, <i>teaching facts and skills is a manifest function of the education system</i>)	Unintended result of a social structure (eg, <i>contributing to social inequality is a latent function of the education system</i>)

Structural functionalism is a **macro-level** (large-scale) sociological perspective that compares modern society to a **biological organism**. This theory proposes that as the various organ systems cooperate to maintain an organism's homeostasis, social institutions work together in the interest of societal balance, known as dynamic equilibrium.

From the structural functionalist perspective, social institutions have **manifest functions**, which are **expected**, and **latent functions**, which are **unintended**. For example, the higher education system is meant to teach students the skills necessary to become functioning citizens in society (eg, manifest function), but many students also end up meeting potential romantic partners in college (eg, latent function).

The passage describes the unintended consequence of industrialization producing "masculine" and "feminine" jobs and the knowledge economy producing a decline in blue-collar jobs and an increase in pink-collar jobs. Both of these are *latent functions* from the functionalism perspective.

(Choice A) Symbolic interactionism, a micro-level (small-scale) sociological perspective, is concerned with person-to-person interactions using symbols (eg, language, signs, objects/behaviors that have subjective meaning). The passage describes large-scale social changes, not small-scale interactions.

(Choice B) Exchange-rational choice refers to two micro-level (small-scale) sociological perspectives. Social exchange theory proposes that interactions between people are based on each person's calculation of benefits and costs; rational choice theory proposes that humans make rational decisions to maximize gain and minimize loss. The passage describes large-scale social changes, not small-scale interactions or individual decisions.

(Choice C) Conflict theory, a macro-level (large-scale) sociological perspective, is concerned with the class conflict that arises when resources (eg, wealth, power) are unevenly distributed across social groups (eg, rich vs. poor). The passage does not describe any sort of conflict between social classes.

Educational objective:

Structural functionalism is a macro-level sociological perspective proposing that social institutions work together to maintain societal balance (dynamic equilibrium). Social institutions have manifest (intended) functions and latent (unintended) functions.

Time spent: 0 sec
 Subject:
 Behavioral Sciences

QID: 401491
 System:
 Demographics and Social Structure

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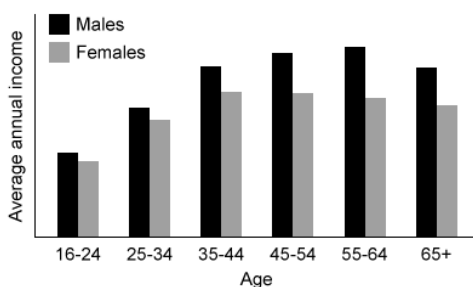


Figure 1 Gender pay gap by age

According to the first paragraph of the passage, industrialization resulted in which of the following sociological processes?

- ☐ A. McDonaldization of society [14%]
- ☐ B. Malthusian population growth [2%]
- ☐ C. A decline in bureaucracy [2%]
- ✓ ☒ D. An increase in the division of labor [80%]

Correct
80% answered correctly

Explanation:

Division of labor	
Advantages	Disadvantages
↑ Efficiency/specialization	↑ Boredom/monotony
↑ Production	↑ Labor exploitation
↓ Costs	↓ Quality

Division of labor refers to the **specialization** of tasks in society that are **interdependent**. In agrarian societies, nearly everyone engaged in the same form of labor (eg, farming) and produced what they needed for survival (eg, tools). In industrialized societies, tasks became more specialized and divided: one person farms, another makes tools in a factory, and everyone purchases or trades for what they need and did not produce.

Division of labor has both advantages and disadvantages. When labor is divided among multiple individuals who each perform one task (rather than one individual performing all of the tasks) to accomplish the end product, each individual can specialize, which increases efficiency and quantity while reducing costs. However, this also can result in the exploitation of labor, reduced quality, and workers becoming bored with monotonous tasks.

According to the first paragraph, industrialization resulted in increased occupational specialization (an increase in the division of labor).

(Choice A) The McDonaldization of society describes when social structures (eg, health care, education) increase efficiency, quantity, standardization, and automation at the expense of individuality, quality, and a skilled workforce. Although the McDonaldization of society has its roots in industrialization, this is not described in the passage.

(Choice B) The Malthusian theory of population growth suggests that human populations increase exponentially but the resources needed to sustain those populations (eg, food) increase much more slowly, resulting in preventive checks that voluntarily decrease the birth rate and positive checks that involuntarily increase the death rate in society. Malthusian population growth is not described in the passage.

(Choice C) Industrialization led to an increase, not a decrease, in bureaucracies, which involve divisions in labor and are hierarchically organized and impersonal social structures.

Educational objective:

The division of labor refers to the specialization of employment into interdependent jobs. The division of labor has positive consequences (eg, increased specialization, efficiency, reduced costs) and negative consequences (eg, labor exploitation, increased boredom, reduced quality).

Time spent:0 sec
Subject:
Behavioral Sciences

QID:401492
System:
Demographics and Social Structure

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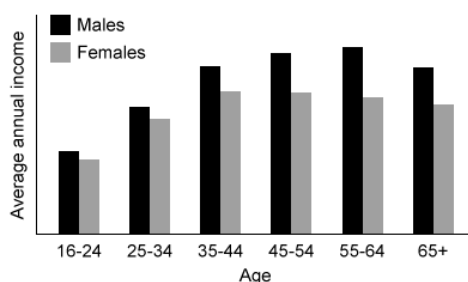


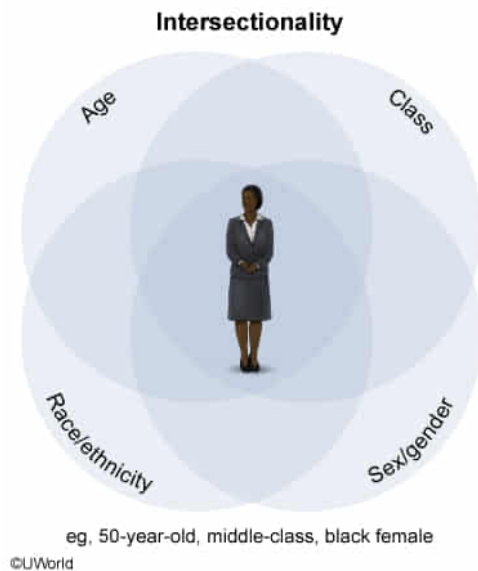
Figure 1 Gender pay gap by age

Does the gender pay gap depicted in Figure 1 illustrate intersectionality?

- ☐ A. No; race and class are not represented in Figure 1. [51%]
- ☐ B. No; males are also negatively affected by the gender pay gap when they approach retirement age. [2%]
- ☒ C. Yes; the gender pay gap reflects income inequalities as a result of multiple social identities. [40%]
- ☐ D. Yes; the gender pay gap is negatively correlated with age. [5%]

Correct
40% answered correctly

Explanation:



Intersectionality describes the **multiple**, interconnected **social identities** (eg, gender, age, race, class) that intersect to impact individuals' **lives**, **perspectives**, and **treatment** in society. The gender pay gap (or gender wage gap) depicted in Figure 1 illustrates how the inequality in pay between female and male workers is related to both gender and age, which is an example of intersectionality.

(Choice A) Despite the fact that race and class are not depicted, Figure 1 *does* display how two social identities (ie, gender and age) intersect to impact wages, which is an example of intersectionality.

(Choice B) Males, who consistently earn more money than females across their lifetime according to Figure 1, are *not* directly negatively affected by the gender pay gap.

(Choice D) According to Figure 1, the gender pay gap appears to be *positively* (not negatively) correlated with age: For most of the adult lifespan, as age increases, the gap in pay between males and females also increases. The gender pay gap only shows a slight decrease for age 65+.

Educational objective:

Intersectionality suggests that for each individual, multiple social identities (eg, gender, age, race, class) intersect to impact one's life, perspective, and treatment by others in society.

Time spent:0 sec
Subject:
Behavioral Sciences

QID:401493
System:
Demographics and Social Structure

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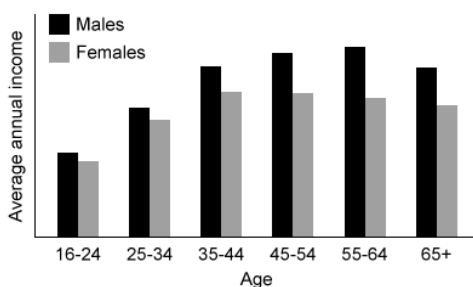


Figure 1 Gender pay gap by age

Which hypothesis regarding pay inequalities and fertility patterns is best supported by information in the passage regarding females in the U.S. workplace? If the age-specific fertility rate for females age 25–29 increases:

- ✓ ☒ A. the gender pay gap for females age 25–29 will increase. [84%]
- ☐ B. the gender pay gap for females age 25–29 will decrease. [9%]
- ☐ C. the demand for males in pink-collar occupations will increase. [5%]
- ☐ D. the demand for males in pink-collar occupations will decrease.

Correct
84% answered correctly

Explanation:

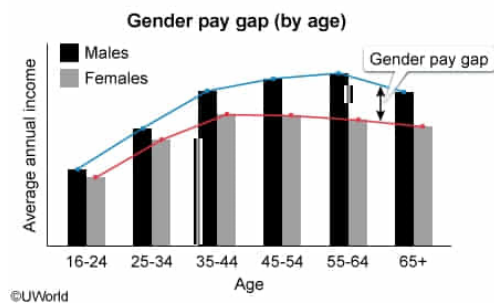


Figure 1 demonstrates that the discrepancy between male's and female's income (the gender pay gap) increases across the adult life span, and only shows a slight narrowing at age 65+. The final paragraph of the passage states that mothers earn less than men and women who are not mothers (the "motherhood penalty"), which suggests that changes in fertility patterns in the U.S. may also impact the gender pay gap.

The **fertility rate** is a measure of the number of people being added to a given population through birth, as opposed to immigration. Of the multiple ways to express fertility rates, the **age-specific fertility rate** (ASFR) describes the number of live births per year per **1,000 women in a certain age group** in a population. In the U.S., the ASFR for women age 25–29 is about 100 whereas the ASFR for women age 40–44 is about 10.

If the ASFR for females age 25–29 increases, then more women in this age cohort will become mothers, which would likely cause the gender pay gap for females age 25–29 to increase.

(Choice B) Increases in the ASFR for females age 25–29 would likely *increase*, not decrease, the gender pay gap.

(Choices C and D) The passage does not provide any evidence suggesting that changes in the ASFR for females for any age cohort is linked to the demand for males in pink-collar occupations.

Educational objective:

Fertility rates measure of the number of people being added to a population through birth. The age-specific fertility rate (ASFR) describes the number of live births per year per 1,000 women in a certain age group in a population.

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Subject:
Behavioral Sciences

QID: 401494
System:
Demographics and Social Structure

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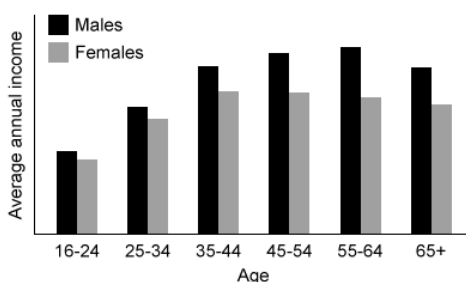


Figure 1 Gender pay gap by age

A feminist theorist would be most interested in which of the following?

- ☐ A. Equalizing pay between females in pink-collar and blue-collar occupations [20%]
- ✓ ☒ B. Removing barriers to entry in all occupations for females [50%]
- ☐ C. Creating more access for males in pink-collar occupations [2%]
- ☐ D. Balancing the percentage of females and males within each occupation [26%]

Correct

50% answered correctly

Explanation:

Major theoretical approaches to sociology			
Theory	Description	Perspective	Theorists
Functionalism	- Society = an organism - Each part of society works to maintain dynamic equilibrium (homeostasis)	Macro	Émile Durkheim, Talcott Parsons
Conflict	- Society = struggle for limited resources - Inequality based on social class	Macro	Karl Marx, Max Weber
Social constructionism	- Social actors define what is real - Knowledge about world based on interactions	Macro or micro	(Not critical for exam)
Symbolic interactionism	- Meaning & value attached to symbols - Individual interactions based on these symbols	Micro	Charles Cooley, George Herbert Mead
Rational choice/social exchange	Individual behaviors & interactions attempt to maximize personal gain & minimize personal cost	Micro	(Not critical for exam)
Feminist	Examines gender inequality in society	Macro or micro	(Not critical for exam)

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In sociology, **feminist theory** explains **differences in power** between males/masculinity and females/femininity in society, known as **gender inequality**. Feminist theory includes both macro- and micro-level approaches.

At the macro-level, feminist theory considers how *social structures* maintain gender inequality. For example, workplace practices that discriminate against women (eg, less pay, fewer promotions) result in the underrepresentation of women in certain fields (eg, surgery). At the micro-level, feminist theory considers how *one-on-one interactions* also maintain gender inequality by objectifying or devaluing females/femininity. For example, patients often assume a female surgeon is a nurse.

Removing barriers to female entry into a variety of occupations is consistent with a macro-level feminist theory concern as it addresses structural factors that contribute to gender inequality.

(Choice A) Feminist theory would not suggest that females in different occupational fields, which require different skill sets and qualifications, should be paid at the same rate. Instead, feminist theory would focus on how men and women within the same occupational field should be compensated equivalently.

(Choice C) In a patriarchal society, males possess most of the power and prestige; therefore, focusing on increasing access *for males* is less likely to be the goal of feminist theorists than is providing access to power and prestige *to females* who have less of it.

(Choice D) Balancing the number of males and females in a given occupation would seem to remove career choice, which is not a feminist goal. Removing the barriers to access so that *all occupations* become legitimate options for females would be the feminist focus.

Educational objective:

Feminist theory explains differences in power between males/masculinity and females/femininity (gender inequality). Feminist theory examines both macro-level impacts of social structures as well as micro-level factors such as individual prejudice and discrimination.

Time spent:0 sec
Subject:
 Behavioral Sciences

QID:401495
System:
 Demographics and Social Structure